

Data_Scientist — Step 5

Build Data Science Projects

Detailed Learning Notes • CareerCompass

1. Learning Objective

Combine data acquisition, statistics, analysis, modeling and communication into complete portfolio-quality projects.

2. Core Concepts — Detailed Breakdown

End-to-end structure

A strong project moves from problem definition to data, EDA, baseline, modeling, evaluation, interpretation and recommendation.

Data acquisition

Use APIs, databases, CSVs or public datasets. Document source, access date, licensing and known limitations.

Experiment design

Create a baseline and maintain a consistent evaluation protocol. Record experiments rather than relying on memory.

Communication

Present technical findings differently to technical and non-technical audiences.

Reproducibility

Include requirements, setup instructions, data preparation steps, notebooks/scripts and clear output.

3. Recommended Learning Workflow

- Select a question with measurable value.
- Create a project plan and data dictionary.
- Build an analysis baseline.
- Add a predictive or inferential component.
- Document limitations.
- Publish a clean repository and report.

5. Hands-on Project / Practice

Build a demand-forecasting, churn-analysis or customer-segmentation project. Include raw-data acquisition, cleaning, EDA, a statistical or ML component, evaluation, visualization, recommendations and a README explaining how another person can reproduce it.

6. Common Mistakes & Pitfalls

- Building a tutorial clone without independent decisions.
- No clear question or success criterion.
- Mixing exploratory and final conclusions without labeling them.

- Hiding failed experiments.
- Publishing sensitive or licensed data improperly.

7. Completion Checklist

- I have a clear research/business question.
- My data source and assumptions are documented.
- My analysis is reproducible.
- My model/evidence is evaluated appropriately.
- My final report contains actionable conclusions and limitations.

8. Interview / Assessment Questions

- Explain your project in two minutes.
- What failed and what did you learn?
- How did you validate the result?
- What would you do with more data?
- How would you communicate this to a non-technical manager?

9. Recommended References

Data Science Tutorial: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ua-CiDNNj30>

Python for Data Science: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CMEWVn1uZpQ>

Kaggle Learn: <https://www.kaggle.com/learn>

Note: These notes are designed as a structured learning guide. Use the references for deeper, current documentation and hands-on practice.